

Feeding Basics

Happy tummies, healthy bodies



How much & how often

- 🐾 Kittens (under 6 months): 3–4 small meals a day
- 🐾 Adults: 2 meals a day at regular times
- 🐾 Fresh water always — many cats love a fountain
- 🐾 A quality commercial cat food (wet, dry, or a mix) should be the actual diet — cats need nutrients like taurine that only a complete cat food reliably provides
- 🐾 Portion size: check the feeding chart on your food's packaging (it's based on calorie density, which varies by brand) — as a rough starting point, a typical adult cat eats about 1/4 to 1/3 cup of dry food a day, split into 2 meals
- 🐾 Switch foods gradually over 7–10 days to avoid tummy upsets

Treats (a few times a week, not daily)

- 🐾 Small pieces of plain cooked chicken or turkey (no skin, bones, or seasoning)
- 🐾 A small amount of cooked fish like salmon (occasional — too much can cause a thiamine deficiency)
- 🐾 Commercial cat treats: no more than about 10% of daily calories

Never feed your cat

- 🐾 Onions, garlic, chives & leeks
- 🐾 Chocolate, coffee & anything caffeinated
- 🐾 Grapes & raisins
- 🐾 Alcohol & raw dough
- 🐾 Xylitol (in sugar-free gum & candy)
- 🐾 Cooked bones & excessive raw fish
- 🐾 Dog food as a diet — cats need their own nutrients

If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center right away:

(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7

